



PROGRESS REPORT

Mali: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 86 systems and instruments tracked

Of 86 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 58 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 16 did not, 8 carry no stated baseline, and 4 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 76 sources for this place in the window — 15 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-02), 61 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Twelve months built Mali's sovereign infrastructure and its cyber institutions, and left its financing and its rights position where they were or worse. A [Tier III National Data Centre opened](#), a [cybersecurity strategy was adopted](#), [ANSSI was created](#), a [cybercrime criminal chamber began hearing cases](#), the [passport supplier changed from France to China](#), and the [state retook majority control of SOTELMA](#).

Over the same period the [universal access fund cut its 2026 budget by 32%](#), the [mobile-money distributor network fell 46.34%](#), and a [journalist was sentenced before the cybercrime pole](#). The institutions were built faster than anything they were meant to deliver to users.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Conseil national du Numerique	Did not exist	Recommended; not constituted	ADVANCED
Declaration de Ouagadougou on the digital economy	Did not exist	Adopted, recommending WAEMU governments put digital at the centre of national strategies	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Data-management law	None published	Recommended; nothing tabled	ADVANCED
Platform-content enforcement instruction	Did not exist	In force as an instruction, built on existing penal and cybercrime provisions with no new statute	ADVANCED
Startups law	None published	Recommended; nothing tabled	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Autorite de Protection des Donnees a caractere Personnel	Reviewing about 2,000 declaratory files; one 5m FCFA fine and more than 100 formal notices in 2025	More than 1,000 files before a ten-day session, with a Segou regional antenna open	ADVANCED
Data-protection authorisation for DDR beneficiary data	Did not exist	The data-protection authority has authorised the two national demobilisation and integration commissions to collect and process ex-combatant and beneficiary data, and the commissions ran a three-day training on personal-data protection in domestic law covering that data	ADVANCED
Mandatory lease-declaration decree	None published	Draft; no adoption on record	ADVANCED
Benin and Mali data-protection cooperation	Agreed (2025-04)	Agreed; no joint action published since	NO CHANGE
Loi n2013-015 on personal data protection	In force	In force and the stated basis for the authority's sanctions	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AES protocol on AI governance	Did not exist	Recommended between the three confederation states; no text	ADVANCED
Membership of the African Telecommunications Union board	Board member	Re-elected for 2027-2031	ADVANCED, RE-ELECTED
Smart Africa cooperation	Member	Member; skills, cross-border fibre and a possible Transform Africa Summit discussed	NO CHANGE

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Speech prosecutions before the cybercrime pole	None on file	A newspaper editor sentenced to 12 months with six suspended for undermining the credibility of the state, having been arrested in June by the national cybercrime unit, in what a press-freedom body describes as authorities using cybercrime provisions to prosecute journalists	REGRESSED

The data-protection authority advanced on its own account: from about 2,000 declaratory files and a 5m FCFA fine in 2025 to a ten-day session on more than 1,000 files opened on 3 August 2026, with a Segou antenna opened in December 2025. The mandatory lease-declaration decree it was reviewing in October 2025 has not been adopted.

The speech position regressed. At the start of the window nothing was on file; at the end, a [ministerial instruction of 29 July 2026](#) reads existing [cybercrime provisions onto platform content](#) without new legislation, and the [cybercrime pole](#) has convicted a [publication director](#) of undermining the credit of the state.

Four instruments entered the record as recommendations in the window's final week and none as law: a [data-management law](#), a [startups law](#), a [Conseil national du Numerique](#) and an [AES protocol on AI governance](#). Regionally Mali was [re-elected to the ATU board for 2027-2031](#) and carried the AES brief at the [UEMOA salon](#) that adopted the [Declaration de Ouagadougou](#).

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Universal access fund budget	FCFA 41,151,471,000 adopted for 2026	Cut 32% to FCFA 27,886,688,000 on 23 July 2026, after 8% of the annual budget was spent in the first half	REGRESSED

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AGEFAU conventions with the education and employment ministries	Did not exist	Signed, committing the fund to connect every secondary, technical and vocational school by end-2027	ADVANCED
Agence de Gestion du Fonds d'Acces Universel	Under direct Primature tutelle	Under direct Primature tutelle, with a new director-general and a revised work programme	NO CHANGE

Universal access financing ends the window smaller than it began it: AGEFAU's 2026 budget was [cut 32%](#), from [FCFA 41,151,471,000 to FCFA 27,886,688,000, on 23 July 2026](#), after 8% of it was spent in the first six months against receipts at only 56% of forecast, with the cut announced in the same week the fund committed to connect every secondary, technical and vocational school by end-2027.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
ADSL retirement and FTTH migration	Did not exist	Announced; no subscriber or coverage figure published	ADVANCED
International route diversity through the CSquared backbone	Inland routes exposed to the Abidjan, Accra and Lagos landing concentration	An independent subsea route with automated rerouting behind the inland backbone	ADVANCED
Moov Africa Malitel fibre	Fibre plans at previous speeds	Up to 100 Mbps across six cities	ADVANCED
Orange Mali 4G and fibre expansion	Did not exist	300 4G towers, half of them rural, and fibre to about 300,000 households in build	ADVANCED
SMTD-SA as sole national transport-infrastructure operator	Did not exist	Recommended as a law; nothing tabled	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Starlink kit imports	Six-month lifting of the import ban reported October 2024; prohibition on unauthorised equipment restated with a warning of sanctions 2026-03-12	Control, seizure and dismantling operations announced against unauthorised Starlink, Wi-Fi Zone and walkie-talkie equipment nationwide, with operators ordered to cease immediately	REGRESSED
Universal connectivity target	None published	Targeted for 2030 with a roadmap drafted with Burkina Faso and Niger	ADVANCED
Independent internet service providers	One independent provider reported surviving	AFRIBONE reported the sole surviving independent provider, on wholesale IP transit bought at near-retail prices	NO CHANGE
Orange Mali satellite 3G and 4G	In service	In service; no later coverage figure published	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Tier III National Data Centre	Did not exist	In service, hosting state data and framed to carry mutualised AES infrastructure	ADVANCED

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Diesel-to-solar conversion of network sites	Did not exist	In the loan's scope; no site count published	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Agence nationale de la Securite des Systemes d'Information	Did not exist	Created; no budget or staffing published	ADVANCED
Criminal chamber of the national cybercrime pole	Did not exist	Operational and hearing cases	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Strategy 2026-2030	None published	Adopted, with ANSSI created to implement it	ADVANCED

The whole cyber institutional stack was created inside the window: the [National Cybersecurity Strategy 2026-2030 in December 2025](#), the [criminal chamber of the cybercrime pole in May 2026](#), and [ANSSI in June 2026](#) to implement the first. So was the [Tier III National Data Centre, inaugurated on 31 January 2026](#). None of the four has published a budget, a staffing figure or a capacity figure.

Access moved on operator investment rather than public programme: an [EUR 80m IFC-led loan to Orange Mali in November 2025](#) for 300 4G towers and fibre to about 300,000 households, [Moov's fibre speeds doubled in June 2026](#), and [ADSL retirement announced in July 2026](#). Route diversity improved through a third party's subsea capacity rather than a Malian asset.

The positions that did not move are the ones users would notice. Satellite coverage of remote regions carries the same figure it did a year ago. A [universal connectivity target of 2030](#) and a [law consolidating transport infrastructure in SMTD-SA](#) were both recommended in the window's last two weeks and neither has a text. Whether Starlink kits may be imported has been unestablished throughout.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National public key infrastructure and e-signature services	None published	Recommended; no first service named	ADVANCED
Customs systems interconnection for goods in transit	Not held	A pilot exchanging transit-goods data with Ivorian customs is running, framed by the customs administration as cutting fraud and transit delays; no completion date for the full interconnection is given	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Cahier de recensement village register	Governed by Loi n06-023 of 28 June 2006	Formalised in a draft ordinance replacing the 2006 statute, still a hand-kept village ledger	ADVANCED
CIB-AES biometric identity card	Did not exist	Piloted on Malian soil for Burkinabe residents; no Malian enrolment figure published	ADVANCED
E-AES biometric passport	AES common biometric passport launched 2025-01-29, supplied by Idemia	Five categories issued to ICAO specification on a five-year, 34-page book, supplied by Emptech	ADVANCED
AES harmonised travel and identity document specifications	Validated and referred to the heads of state	Validated; five passport categories now issued under them	NO CHANGE
NINA national identity number	In use as the national identity key	In use as the national identity key	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital pension payment	Mobile pension payment live	Bank-channel pilot complete and reported ready for phased rollout to other partner banks	ADVANCED
Moov Money prepaid Mastercard	Did not exist	Live, the second telco-led card	ADVANCED
Cross-border remittances into mobile wallets	Integration announced (2025-05)	Integration announced; no volume published	NO CHANGE
Orange Money prepaid Mastercard	Launched (2025-06)	Launched; caps of 2m FCFA per transaction and 10m FCFA a month	NO CHANGE
TresorPay	Launched (2025-03)	Launched; no transaction figure published	NO CHANGE

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National diaspora skills directory	Did not exist	A national digital directory of diaspora skills was launched at a ceremony in Washington on 22 August 2026, presided over by the minister for Malians abroad and African integration and run by the Malian embassy to the United States; it registers professional profiles across economic, administrative, academic, private-sector and emerging fields so that ministries can identify expertise against specific needs. The minister described it as an accreting database whose usefulness depends on diaspora take-up and on the profiles being kept current	ADVANCED
Birth registration	89.5% registration, 747 centres (2025-06)	No later figure published	NO CHANGE
Death registration	About 20% (2025-06)	About 20%; no later figure published	NO CHANGE
National Agency for the Security of Civil Status Documents	Created (2025)	Created; no output figure published	NO CHANGE
SIF/GUF land information system and one-stop land office	Launched (2025-03)	Launched; no transaction figure published	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National digital health portal	Did not exist	Live with facility geolocation; power, urban-rural divide and interoperability flagged as obstacles	ADVANCED
OpenClinic health information system	Did not exist	In build; stated to link to the NINA and to mandatory health insurance	ADVANCED
Unique patient identifier	Did not exist	Running in the Hopital dermatologie de Bamako across registration, laboratory, consultation and pharmacy	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Government action monitoring and evaluation system	Did not exist	Operating and publishing completion rates	ADVANCED
Government Intranet	None published	13 services integrated, with a draft decree to make government messaging mandatory	ADVANCED
Integrated human resources management system	Did not exist	Reported in build; no scope or completion figure published	ADVANCED
Online criminal record and nationality certificate	Did not exist	Live, applications keyed on the NINA with an E-verif authenticity check	ADVANCED
SIGIP territorial administration data management	Did not exist	In build; no deployment figure published	ADVANCED
Sigui-Dolo driving licence and vehicle registration	Did not exist	Live and linked to TresorPay and the SYDONIA customs system	ADVANCED
Diaspora services platform	Launched (2025-02)	Launched; no usage figure published	NO CHANGE
.ml country-code domain administration	BASELINE NOT HELD	13,441 domain names across 30 registrars	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Government action plan execution	BASELINE NOT HELD	43.43% of planned activities completed in the second half of 2025 – 109 of 251, with 83 in progress and 59 not started	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Identity moved twice, in the same direction. The [AES common passport of January 2025](#) became the [E-AES passport in five ICAO-specification categories](#), with [Emptech of China](#) replacing [Idemia of France](#) as supplier in [October 2025](#), and the [CIB-AES card](#) was [piloted in Bamako in June 2026](#) for another confederation state's residents. Underneath it, the [village register](#) from which family record books are issued was given a new legal form in [July 2026](#) and remains a hand-kept ledger. [Birth registration at 89.5%](#) and [death registration at about 20%](#) are the same figures the base held a year ago.

Service platforms multiplied: [online criminal-record and nationality certificates](#) in February 2026, [Sigui-Dolo, OpenClinic and SIGIP](#) presented in September 2025, a [national health portal](#) in July 2026, and a [unique patient identifier running in one hospital](#). Almost none of them publishes a usage figure. The two that do publish numbers are unflattering: government's own monitoring system reported [43.43% of planned activities completed for the second half of 2025](#), and [digital payment at civil registry centres](#) raised about [FCFA 200 million](#) across 23 months.

The market moved backwards where it counts for users. A [second telco-led prepaid card](#) launched in [April 2026](#), but the [BCEAO records distributor numbers down 46.34%](#) in 2024, the steepest fall in the Union, and [Mali's share of Union transaction value down from 12.1% to 11.7%](#) – the cash-in and cash-out counter contracting while two state flows are pushed onto digital rails.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital payment at civil registry centres	BASELINE NOT HELD	About FCFA 200m collected between July 2024 and May 2026, with every collectivite ordered to report within 30 days	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Koutiala commune fiscal census and financial management digitisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Surveying taxable commercial equipment and public-space use and equipping the town hall with digital financial-management tools, to widen the commune's own-source revenue	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Rural and white-zone coverage	No white-zone map published	An updated universal-access strategy with a white-zone map recommended, against a 2030 universal connectivity target	ADVANCED

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Francophone West African AI governance guidelines	Did not exist	Adopted, led by the advocacy organisation Niyel and announced at the Global Dialogue on AI Governance	ADVANCED
MIA operator AI assistant	Did not exist	Launched by Moov Africa Malitel	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National AI strategy	None published	Recommended; no draft published	ADVANCED
Centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating; one demonstration on record	Baseline not held

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
State shareholding in SOTELMA	49% state-held with Maroc Telecom in majority control	56% state-held, Maroc Telecom cut to a minority, licence renewed	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Citizen content reporting and checking application	Did not exist	A civil-society organisation launched an application for reporting and checking online content, reported on 24 August 2026 alongside the closing report of its digital campaign against viral falsehood, which it says reached 68,885 people; the application is aimed at young people and civil-society organisations, and the work is funded through a Danish foreign-ministry facility with support from the ministry responsible for communication and the digital economy	ADVANCED

Mali acquired an AI position in the window and it is entirely external or advisory: the [Francophone West African governance guidelines adopted in July 2026](#), a national strategy recommended on 1 August and not drafted, and an [operator's customer assistant launched in June 2026](#).

The substantive movement was ownership. The state [went from 49% to 56% of SOTELMA for FCFA 160bn](#) in June 2026, and the supplier of national identity documents changed country.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital-skills programme for 15,000 young people	Did not exist	Recruitment open under a convention with the Association Kabakoo	ADVANCED
Teacher-training institute ICT equipment	Did not exist	Delivered to eight institutes; no maintenance, connectivity or software provision stated	ADVANCED
Orange Digital Center graduates	BASELINE NOT HELD	350 young people placed on the labour market (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Higher-education and research digital capacity	No long-term national research strategic plan on record and a 1:100 teacher-student ratio at the University of Bamako (2009)	Universite Numerique du Mali strategic framework and action plan validated; 132,186 students across 16 higher-education institutions and an 81:1 student-teacher ratio against UNESCO's 25:1 norm (2024-05)	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Main news source shares	No survey-based ranking of main news sources held	Radio is the main news source for 27.3 per cent and television for 21.7 per cent, with a short-video platform third at 19.7 per cent, ahead of family and word of mouth at 9.4, a social network at 8.5, internet sites at 6.9, a messaging application at 4.8, a video platform at 0.4, and the printed press and a microblogging platform at 0.1 each; 1.3 per cent did not know (n=2,219)	ADVANCED
Mobile data affordability against Senegal	Not held	About 1.5GB of mobile data in Bamako for what buys about 25GB in Dakar, a ratio of roughly 25 to 1, attributed by critics to weak market oversight by the regulator, the duopoly of the two incumbent operators and the years since a new operator licence was issued	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Women's digital-training target	Did not exist	Target set; no interim figure published	ADVANCED

AGEFAU committed to connect every secondary, technical and vocational school by end-2027, a target set three years inside the 2030 universal connectivity date.

Training commitments were made rather than delivered: a 15,000-youth programme whose first cohort opened for recruitment on 1 August 2026, 350 graduates reported by an operator, FCFA 88,740,927 of donated equipment for eight teacher-training institutes, and a 70%-by-2032 women's training target with no interim figure.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
INSTAT microdata catalogue	None published	NADA microdata archive under INSTAT's own domain holding 107 studies, led by the 2022 census (RGPH5) and near-annual agricultural surveys since 1996/1997	ADVANCED
Mali's share of UEMOA electronic money	12.1% of Union transaction value (2023)	11.7% of Union value and 10.7% of volume in 2024, on 18.58% volume growth and 7.29% of accounts opened	ADVANCED, SHARE OF THE UNION DOWN
Mobile-money distribution network	Distributor network at its 2023 level	Distributor numbers down 46.34% in 2024, the steepest fall in the Union	REGRESSED

Geopolitics

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Foreign supplier of national identity documents	Supplied by Idemia of France	Supplied by Emptech of China	ADVANCED

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
EU multiannual indicative programme 2021-2027	EUR 151m committed 2021-2024 for growth and green economy, and human development and youth	No dedicated 2025-2027 Mali country programme; funded instead from the complex-settings allocation for the central Sahel, with no digital or data-governance activity named in either tranche	REGRESSED

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
e& Partner2Connect digital-infrastructure pledge	Did not exist	\$6bn committed 2024-2026 across 16 markets including Mali and Niger, undivided between them; no Mali-specific allocation published	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Data Centre capacity	A rack, floor-area, power or storage figure for Mali's Tier III National Data Centre, from the digital economy ministry, AGETIC or the builder.	2026-08-10
Open-data portal or policy	A Malian government open-data portal, open-data policy or right-to-information instrument, or an official statement that none exists.	2026-08-10
United States bilateral digital cooperation	A US government programme document, agreement or funding decision on digital or data cooperation with Mali after the 2023 Digital Ecosystem Country Assessment.	2026-08-10
India bilateral digital cooperation	A bilateral memorandum, DPI cooperation programme or ministerial readout naming a Mali-India digital instrument.	2026-08-10

Seven rows carry no position at either end. Two ask a precise question of a system that exists — the National Data Centre's capacity, and whether Starlink imports are lawful since the six-month lifting of October 2024. Three are bilateral relationships the base cannot describe: the European Union's programme for 2025-2027, and any United States or India digital instrument. The last two are an open-data portal or policy and any higher-education or research digital capacity.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-26
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MLI/MLI-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MLI/MLI-progress-2026-08-26.pdf
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.